

Shipment Preparation Guide

What to check and how to adjust a shipment's files before loading them into the program.

Every shipment needs 3 files

File	Where it comes from	Field in the program
Shipment spreadsheet (packing list)	Sent by the client (Excel). It almost always needs adjusting (section 4).	1. Shipment Data
Box labels PDF (4x6)	Downloaded by the client from Amazon Seller Central (FBA box labels).	Big Box Label
FNSKU labels PDF (pairs)	Downloaded by the client from Seller Central (item labels). If they don't have it, Alejo generates it.	Small Box Label

At a glance

- **1.** Save the files in one folder per shipment.
- **2.** Check that the box PDF is 4x6, one label per page, and that its text is searchable.
- **3.** Check the FNSKU labels PDF.
- **4.** Adjust the spreadsheet: headers, columns and leftover rows.
- **5.** Do a test print before starting.

Want to skip step 4? Send Alejo the original spreadsheet and he sends back the ready version, or paste the **AI Context** file into an AI along with the spreadsheet and ask it to guide you.

1 · Where to save the files

Create **one folder per shipment**, named after the Amazon shipment ID, and save everything you receive there. For example:

```
Documents\Shipments\FBA19QHGW04\  
├ 1 client ORIGINAL spreadsheet.xlsx      (never edited)  
├ 2 spreadsheet FOR THE APP.xlsx          (the adjusted one, section 4)  
├ 3 BOX labels 4x6.pdf  
├ 4 FNSKU pair labels.pdf  
└ client instructions email.pdf
```

- You **don't need to copy the files into the program**. When you load the shipment you pick them from this folder and the program keeps its own copy.
- Always keep the **original spreadsheet untouched**. If something goes wrong while adjusting it, you start again from there.

Don't touch the C:\ShippingTool\output folder

That's where the program keeps the shipment in progress and which boxes are done. Don't put files there, rename them or delete them.

2 · Check the box labels PDF (4x6)

This is the most important one: it's where the label stuck on each master box comes from. Check three things.

1

One label per page, 4x6 size

When you press **Big Box**, the program prints **the whole page** that label is on. If the page has 2 or 4 labels, it prints all of them together, shrunk.



YES

4x6: one label per page



NO

Letter sheet with several labels

If they send the Letter or A4 version, ask for the **“Thermal printing” / 4x6** one. In Seller Central it's chosen when downloading the box labels.

2

The text must be searchable

The program finds each label by **reading the PDF's text**. Open the PDF, press **Ctrl+F** and search for a box ID from the spreadsheet, for example:

```
FBA19QHGW04U000001
```

If it finds it, you're fine. If it finds nothing, the PDF is a scan or a photo and won't work: ask for the original PDF downloaded from Seller Central.

3**Don't modify it**

Don't print it to another PDF, rotate it, compress it or remove pages. The page order doesn't matter. If the client sends several box PDFs, ask for a single one with all of them.

3 · Check the FNSKU labels PDF (pairs)

- From this PDF the program only takes **the FNSKU code** (starts with X00...) **and the product name**. The program draws the label itself, so **it doesn't matter how many labels there are per page**.
- Do the same test: **Ctrl+F** and search for an FNSKU from the spreadsheet (for example **X004IXFTO3**). It must be found.
- Each label must have, in this order: the FNSKU, the product name and the word **New**, like the standard Amazon labels.
- If the client doesn't send it, or the pairs already come labeled, tell Alejo: it can be generated from the spreadsheet.

4 · Adjust the spreadsheet

The program looks for columns with **exact names**. The client's spreadsheet almost always uses other names, so they must be renamed. These are the 5 it needs:

Exact name	What it must contain
UPC/EAN (GTIN)	What you will scan or type to find the box. See the box below.
Master Box #	The title shown on each row. Use something easy to recognise: "Box 4 - ARIZONA EVA WHITE 37".
Quantity	Number of pairs on that row. It's how many small labels Shoes prints.
FNSKU	The product's FNSKU code (X00...). It must be in the FNSKU labels PDF.
Amazon Labels	The Amazon box ID (FBA...U000001). It must be in the 4x6 box PDF.

Key point: whatever you put in **UPC/EAN (GTIN)** is what you will scan or type.

- If you scan the **shoe box**: put the product's UPC there (that's how Hoka was done).
- If you type the **master box reference**, like 453909: put that reference there (that's how Birkenstock is done).

Step by step in Excel (example: Birkenstock)

The column letters are those of the file **VCA PL BIRKENSTOCK 6747 sin columnas.xlsx**. In another file they may differ: go by the headers.

1

Make a copy

Open the original spreadsheet and use **File > Save As** with another name, for example **2 spreadsheet FOR THE APP.xlsx**. Always work on the copy.

2

Headers on row 1

If there is a title above the headers (for example **PACKING LIST · 630 UNIDADES**), delete that row: right-click the row number > **Delete**. Row 1 must be the header row.

3

Rename 3 headers

Column	Says	Type
D	Pallet Salida	UPC/EAN (GTIN)
H	QTY	Quantity
L	AMAZON Labels	Amazon Labels

FNSKU (column K) already has the right name. Copy the names exactly, with capitals, spaces and brackets.

4

Mark the boxes that don't go to Amazon

The **set aside** boxes have no Amazon label. Select column L, **Data > Filter**, in column L's filter tick only (**Blanks**). Select the visible blank cells in L (not the header), type **SET ASIDE** and press **Ctrl+Enter**: it fills all of them. Then clear the filter.

5

Add the Master Box # column

In the first empty column (N), type **Master Box #** in N1 and this formula in N2:

Excel in English:

```
=IF(L2="SET ASIDE","Box "&E2&" - SET ASIDE (NO VA A AMAZON) - "&C2&" "&B2,"Box "&E2&" - "&C2&" "&B2)
```

Excel in Spanish:

```
=SI(L2="SET ASIDE";"Box "&E2&" - SET ASIDE (NO VA A AMAZON) - "&C2&" "&B2;"Box "&E2&" - "&C2&" "&B2)
```

It should show something like **Box 1 - ARIZONA EVA WHITE 37**. Then double-click the small square at the cell's corner to copy the formula all the way down.

6

Sort the rows

The program shows the boxes in the spreadsheet's order. Select all (Ctrl+A) > **Data > Sort**: first by **UPC/EAN (GTIN)** and then by **BOX O**, smallest to largest.

7

Delete the rows at the bottom

At the end of the spreadsheet there are usually totals (6747) and loose data (Box, Weight, CBM). Delete those whole rows: if they stay, they appear as empty rows in **View Data** and in the progress total. **Careful**: if you sorted first, check that the totals didn't end up at the top.

8

Save as .xlsx

Save with **Ctrl+S**, in Excel format (.xlsx).

Don't save it as CSV from Excel

Excel in some languages (like Spanish) saves CSV files separated with ; and the program reads them as a single column. Excel can also turn long codes into numbers like **1.98605E+11**. Upload the **.xlsx** directly. If you need a CSV, use Google Sheets > File > Download > CSV.

Check the totals

Add up the **Quantity** column and compare it with the client's email. For Birkenstock: **6,747** pairs in total, **6,223** go to Amazon (586 boxes) and **524** stay (set aside). If it doesn't match, ask the client before starting.

5 · Before starting: test print

- ☐ Both printers have the right roll loaded: small labels for the pairs and **4x6** for the boxes.
- ☐ You have **enough labels**: one small label per pair (6,223 for Birkenstock) and one 4x6 per box (586), plus spares for mistakes.
- ☐ Load the shipment into the program with the 3 files (**Upload & Process**).
- ☐ Type a reference (for example **453909**) and press Enter: its boxes must appear.
- ☐ On one row, press **Big Box**: the whole 4x6 label must come out, straight and at label size. Check that the printed **FBA...U000...** number is the same as the one on the row.
- ☐ Try **Shoes** on a row with few pairs, and scan the printed label with the barcode scanner into Notepad: it must type the FNSKU (X00...).
- ☐ **Don't press Mark Done** during the test unless that box is really finished.

If the label comes out tiny, cut off or sideways, the problem is the printer's **paper size** in Windows: Settings > Printers > (the printer) > Printing preferences.

If the client sends corrected files mid-way

Uploading the files again erases the progress.

Before doing anything, press **Download (CSV)** to save which boxes are already done, and tell Alejo. Don't load the new spreadsheet over the shipment in progress.